

BranchX's AI Revolution: Digitizing India's Kirana Stores Ahead of IPO



Mr. Sajid Jamal
Managing Director & Founder



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CEO & Co-founder

In the bustling lanes of India's neighborhood kirana stores, a quiet digital transformation is underway. Fintech startup BranchX is leading the charge with its AI-powered neobank, turning traditional small shops into data-smart businesses. As the company eyes a landmark Initial Public Offering (IPO) in 2027, it's not just raising capital - it's validating its mission to unify India's fragmented retail ecosystem.

Launched earlier this year in 2025, BranchX's flagship AI-powered point-of-sale (POS) assistant, Xenie, has already made waves. The Company has onboarded over 400,000 retailers through strategic channel partners, connected more than 100 leading brands, and processed transactions exceeding \$1 billion. These figures underscore the massive potential in India's retail sector, which accounts for over 10% of the nation's GDP but remains largely informal and data-deprived.

At its core, BranchX addresses age-old challenges faced by millions of small retailers who rely on gut instinct rather than insights. Distributors handle manual processes, while brands lack real-time market data. Xenie changes that by acting as a multilingual virtual advisor, speaking in local languages to offer voice-enabled guidance on sales trends, profit margins, inventory needs, and payment schedules. It's like having



Xenie Cube POS

a business consultant right at the shop counter.

"Our vision goes beyond fintech, it's about empowering India's small shopkeepers with the intelligence that big corporations enjoy," said Sajid Jamal, Managing Director of BranchX. "When the smallest retailer gets smarter, the whole ecosystem thrives - it's a win for everyone."

The company's growth story is equally impressive. From humble beginnings with \$0.25 million in revenue in 2022, BranchX hit \$15 million in Gross Transaction Value (GTV) within just six months of its enhanced platform launch in 2023. Key moves included acquiring a remittance platform in 2021 and partnering with M2P for prepaid payment instrument (PPI) cards, bolstering its financial services.

"What we're creating has real social impact alongside strong business

value," added Rajesh Johnny, CEO of BranchX. "India's retail market is huge but scattered. By blending AI, data, and finance, we're boosting efficiency and profits for retailers, distributors, and brands alike. This isn't just a fintech tale - it's the future of commerce."

The upcoming IPO is a pivotal chapter for BranchX, signaling confidence in its role as the digital backbone of India's retail infrastructure. Set for 2027, the public listing will fuel expansion into Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities, where most retail activity occurs but digital adoption lags. Funds will enhance AI capabilities, infrastructure, and partnerships, accelerating the shift to data-driven commerce at the grassroots level.

"An IPO isn't merely about funding - it's about solidifying BranchX as the core of India's retail economy," Jamal emphasized. "It will provide the resources and trust needed to scale rapidly, forge deeper alliances, and create lasting value for retailers, distributors, and investors."

As India pushes towards a \$5 trillion economy, BranchX's journey highlights how AI can democratize opportunities for the unorganized sector. With kirana stores forming the lifeblood of local communities, this fintech innovator is poised to rewrite the rules of retail - one smart transaction at a time.